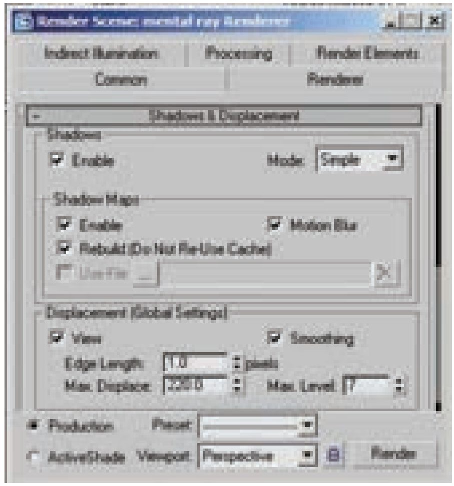
5 Rendering



Rendering will make your artistry a reality

Rendering is the process whereby your 3ds Max scenes come together into an image. Just as you print film in the darkroom, you truly create an image by rendering it. Creating good renders involves knowing a little bit about the technology behind the scenes, such as the way lights and cameras interact, as well as the way 3ds Max and mental ray smooth and antialias images. Although knowing the technology can get you to the point where you can render almost anything, it's your artist's eye that puts this knowledge to use and makes the difference between a good image and a truly great one.

5.1 Renderers

3ds Max has two basic renderers that come with the software: the scanline renderer and mental ray. The type of renderer is selected by using the Assign Renderer rollout of the Render Scene dialog box. 3ds Max's scanline renderer is a fast and robust rendering solution. It produces excellent images and can create advanced effects such as radiosity for architectural and design applications. Mental ray is an industry standard renderer that is used by various other packages. It provides advanced lighting simulations to create global illumination and caustics. Most 3ds Max lights, cameras, and materials will work with both renderers, though each renderer has its own set of tools for those areas that don't overlap. Rendering can be started by using the render icons on the main toolbar.

ActiveShade renders the scene in the ActiveShade window, which allows for interactive rendering

Quick Render renders the scene by using the current settings. Render Type allows you to render the view, selected objects and regions. Render Scene brings up the Render Scene window.